

OBEY THE LAW

**A
TRUE
WILD WEST
STORY**

JOAQUIN MURRIETA

**NO EVIL DEED WOULD SATISFY
HIS HUNGER FOR DESTRUCTION!**

**ONLY ONE MAN DARED TO
STAND AGAINST HIS TERROR!**

JOAQUIN
MURRIETA

1832-1855

HA, HA, HA!
NOW HERE IS A
FINE LOOKING
GALLOWS IF I EVER SAW
ONE—THE STURDIEST
GALLOWS IN ALL OF
CALIFORNIA, THEY SAY!
AND I HAVE HEARD IT
WAS BUILT ESPECIALLY
FOR MY NECK—THE
CHOICE NECK OF
JOAQUIN MURRIETA!
HA, HA, HA!

YES, MURRIETA—I WAS BUILT FOR THAT
ONE PURPOSE, BUT I NEVER DID GET
YOUR SLIMY NECK IN MY GRASP—THOUGH
THERE WAS NO NECK IN ALL OF CALIFORNIA
I WOULD RATHER HAVE SNAPPED—FOR
YOURS WAS A CAREER IN CRIME THAT
HAS SELDOM BEEN PARALLELED, AND
LEFT BEHIND IT A BLOODY STAIN
ON THE HISTORY OF THAT
GREAT STATE!

BUT WHY TELL YOU?
YOU'RE DEAD NOW—AND THE
ONLY WORTHWHILE MEMORY YOU LEFT
IS THE MORAL LESSON THE WORLD CAN
LEARN FROM YOUR SINFUL RECORD, AND I GUESS
I'M THE ONE WHO CAN TELL THE WORLD, IF ANYONE
CAN! LOOK BACK TO MURRIETA'S DAYS ON THE WILD
FRONTIER—I WAS THE ONE STANCH DEFENDER OF MEN'S
RIGHTS, AND THE FEAR I STRUCK IN MEN'S HEARTS WAS
ONE OF THE IMPORTANT THINGS THAT KEPT THE WEST
TOGETHER AND LET IT GROW TO ITS PRESENT GREATNESS!
I PROTECTED PEOPLE'S POSSESSIONS FROM HORSE-
THIEVES AND CATTLE RUSTLERS! I PROTECTED THEIR
LIVES FROM THE LUSTFUL MURDERERS WHO TERRORIZED
FRONTIER TOWNS! IN A WAY, I WAS THE ONE SYMBOL
OF JUSTICE IN THOSE LAWLESS DAYS! AND I'M
PROUD OF WHAT I ACCOMPLISHED—BUT THERE
IS ONE BLOT ON MY RECORD—THE MAN
I WANTED MOST TO HANG ELUDED MY NOOSE!
WHY DID I WANT HIS LIFE SO BADLY?
WELL, IT'S A LONG STORY, AND AFTER
I'VE TOLD IT, YOU'LL AGREE THAT
JOAQUIN MURRIETA WAS BORN
FOR THE GALLOWS!

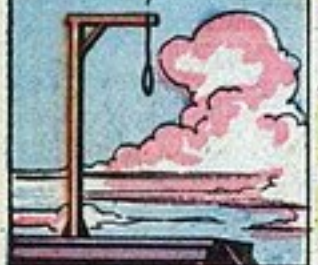
IN
CONSIDERATION
OF INNOCENT
PEOPLE INVOLVED
AND RELATIVES OF
OTHERS, THE NAMES
OF SOME CHARACTERS
DEPICTED IN THIS TRUE
MAGAZINE ARE
FICTITIOUS.

The editors

ADAPTATION
and ART by
DAN
BARRY

OBEY THE LAW

YES, I KNEW THAT MURRIETA WAS ONE OF MY CHOSEN SUBJECTS! HE WAS IN MY DOMAIN EVER SINCE HE WAS A BOY! FOR, DESPITE HIS WEALTHY PARENTS AND CULTURED BACKGROUND, HE BURNED WITH A PATHOLOGICAL EGOTISM, A SEETHING DESIRE TO EXCEL IN EVERYTHING—WHETHER HE DID SO FAIRLY OR NOT! WHEN HE WAS FOURTEEN, HE ENTERED A HORSEMANSHIP CONTEST AT HIS MILITARY SCHOOL IN SONORA, MEXICO...



HE WAS A PRETTY GOOD RIDER, BUT ONE BOY WAS AHEAD OF HIM AS THEY CAME TO THE LAST HURDLE!

DEVIL! I'LL SHOW HIM WHO IS THE GREATER HORSEMAN—IF I HAVE TO BREAK HIS NECK ON THIS JUMP!

JOAQUIN! LOOK OUT! YOU'RE CROWDING ME! WE'LL BE HURT!



I RECOGNIZED THE THREAT OF MURDER IN JOAQUIN'S EYE AS HE TRIED TO UNSEAT HIS OPPONENT—BUT THE BOY WAS A SUPERIOR RIDER, AND JOAQUIN WOUND UP IN A SPILL HIMSELF!

I TOLD YOU TO BE CAREFUL, YOU FOOL!

GOX!! YOU FILTHY SWINE! YOU TRICKED ME! OOH!!



ALBUINO, RAMON—YOU HAVE WON FIRST PRIZE! WE ARE PROUD TO AWARD YOU THIS TROPHY IN RECOGNITION OF...

PIG! HE UPSET MY HORSE! HE DID IT DELIBERATELY! I'LL CUT HIS HEART OUT!

JOAQUIN! STOP, YOU FOOL!



JOAQUIN, YOU FOOL! HAVE YOU LOST YOUR MIND? DROP THAT KNIFE!

JUAN! YOU TURN AGAINST ME! UGH!!



NO—I HAVE JUST SAVED YOU FROM COMMITTING AN INSANE ACT! I WAS YOUR FRIEND, BUT NOW I AM ASHAMED OF THAT FACT!

JOAQUIN MURRIETA, YOU HAVE DISGRACED OUR ACADEMY! YOU HAVE LEARNED NOTHING FROM OUR TEACHINGS OF SPORTSMANSHIP AND FAIR PLAY, AS EVIDENCED BY THIS DISGUSTING DISPLAY! GO TO YOUR ROOM AND PACK! YOU WILL BE SENT HOME TOMORROW!



...BUT THAT NIGHT... THE DOGS! THEY WILL NOT SEND JOAQUIN MURRIETA HOME IN DISGRACE LIKE A STUPID CHILD! I WILL GO TO CALIFORNIA AND JOIN MY BROTHER, CARLOS, AT HIS GOLD MINE—AND WHEN I AM RICH AND POWERFUL, THEY WILL RUE THE DAY WHEN THEY TREATED ME WITH DISRESPECT! ADIOS, MEXICO—WHEN I RETURN, YOU WILL KISS MY KNEES, AND KNEEL IN THE DUST OF MY FOOTSTEPS!



THIS WAS YOUNG JOAQUIN AT FOURTEEN—A FRUSTRATED EGOMANIAC, WHO WOULD KILL AT THE DROP OF A HAT! I KNEW THEN THAT HE WOULD SOME DAY HAVE EARNED A TRIP TO MY SCAFFOLD! HIS TYPE OF AMBITION CARRIED HATE AND BITTERNESS WITH IT—AND DESTROYED ANYONE WHO STOOD IN HIS WAY!

WELL, HE DID GET TO CALIFORNIA, BUT HIS BROTHER, CARLOS, WASN'T EASY TO FIND! JOAQUIN GOT IN AND OUT OF MANY TROUBLES IN THE NEXT TWO YEARS—AND AT THE RIPE OLD AGE OF SIXTEEN, HE SHOWED UP IN SAN FRANCISCO WITH A PRETTY YOUNG BRIDE AND A HANDSOME MUSTACHE!



COME, CARMEN, MI QUERIDA, LET US STOP HERE FOR AWHILE! PERHAPS WE WILL HEAR SOME GOSSIP OF MY BROTHER, CARLOS, WHEREABOUTS!

OH, JOAQUIN—I DO NOT LIKE THESE PLACES OF EVIL—THESE BARS AND SALOONS! FOR MONTHS NOW WE HAVE BEEN SPENDING OUR TIME HERE, WHEN WE COULD BE WORKING TO EARN AN HONEST LIVING! WHEN WILL ALL THIS STOP!



OBEY THE LAW



WHAT HAVE I
GOTTEN JOAQUIN
INTO? HE DID
THIS FOR ME!

ALL RIGHT—
YOU HAVE US!
YOU CAN HANG
ME! I STOLE
THE HORSES! MY
BROTHER HAS
HIS OWN, AND
HE KNOWS NOTHING
OF ALL THIS!

SHUT UP,
MISTER! WE'LL
DECIDE WHAT TO
DO WITH YOU—AN
I'M FER HANGIN'
THE WHOLE LOT
OF YOU!

HOLD ON—
JUST A
MINUTE—
I'M THE
SHERIFF!



HE'S RIGHT—HIS
BROTHER DIDN'T
STEAL A HORSE—
BUT HE WAS IN ON
IT—WE CAN GIVE
HIM A FLOGGIN' HE
WON'T FORGET!

YEAH—LET'S TAKE
'EM OUT TO TWIN
OAKS! WE'LL
SHOW 'EM HOW
WE DEAL WITH
HORSE THIEVES!
GET A GOOD,
STRONG ROPE,
CARSON—THE
TRIAL'S OVER!

I GOT
ONE! LET'S
GO!



IT WAS A PRETTY GRIM
PARTY THAT ROSE OUT TO
TWIN OAKS, BUT JOAQUIN
NEVER FLINCHED, AS HE
LET HIS BROTHER
HANG TO SAVE HIS NECK!
IN AN INDIRECT WAY, YOU
MIGHT SAY THIS WAS HIS
FIRST MURDER—HIS OWN
BROTHER! BUT JOAQUIN
COULD NEVER SEE IT
THAT WAY—ALL HE COULD
THINK OF WAS HIS OWN
NECK, AND THE BITTER
SHAME OF BEING
CAPTURED LIKE A
TRAPPED ANIMAL!



OKAY, JENKINS—
THE NOOSE IS
GOOD AN' TIGHT!
SPUR THE
HORSE OFF!

GIVE THAT
OTHER ONE
TWENTY
LASHES!

NO! NO! PLEASE! HAVE
MERCY! HE'S ONLY A
BOY! JOAQUIN!
JOAQUIN! OHH..

OUTTA MY
WAY, LADY—
I GOT
BUSINESS!



THAT'S TWENTY—
UGH! THIS HOMBRE
MUST BE HALF
DEAD! I RECKON
HE'LL NEVER MESS
WITH HORSE-
THEVIN' AGAIN!
LET'S GO!



OH, JOAQUIN! JOAQUIN!
ARE YOU ALL RIGHT? OH,
WHY DID I LET YOU DO IT?
I KNEW STEALING WOULD
LEAD TO NO GOOD, AND
NOW CARLOS IS DEAD—AND
ALL BECAUSE OF US,
JOAQUIN! WHEN WILL
YOU GIVE UP YOUR
SCHEMES AND BE
CONTENT TO LIVE IN
PEACE? HE DOESN'T
HEAR ME—HE'S
UNCONSCIOUS! I
WILL MAKE
HIM WELL!



THERE—THAT IS
BETTER! NOW LIVE
STILL AND SAVE
YOUR STRENGTH!
WHEN YOU ARE
BETTER, WE WILL
RETURN TO MEXICO.
EH, JOAQUIN?

MEXICO? RETURN
BROKEN AND STARVING,
AND LEAVE CARLOS'
DEATH UNAVENGED?
NEVER! I WILL FIND
CARLOS' CLAIM, AND I
WILL BE RICH! THEN I
WILL MAKE THESE
CALIFORNIANS PAY FOR
THIS A THOUSAND TIMES
OVER! A THOUSAND
LIVES FOR THAT
OF CARLOS!



BUT IT WAS NOT
THEIR FAULT! IT
IS THE LAW HERE,
AND WE BROKE
IT! CARLOS PAID
FOR OUR SINS,
JOAQUIN! DON'T
GET UP! WHAT
ARE YOU DOING?

AHA—HERE IT IS—
THE MAP OF
CARLOS' GOLD
CLAIM! THAT IS
WHERE WE ARE
GOING—HA, HA,
WE WILL YET TAKE
OUR FORTUNE
FROM
CALIFORNIA!

OBEDIENT TO THE LAW

